

JONATHAN RICHARDSON, CHARLES CHAUNCY, AND THE MANUSCRIPTS OF POPE

by

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‘As for his *Essay on Man*’, recalled the man of letters Jonathan Richardson the younger, in a volume of reflections published in 1776, five years after his death,

I was witness to the whole conduct of it in writing, and actually have his original MSS. for it, from the first scratches of the four books, to the several finished copies, (of his own neat and elegant writing these last) all which, with the MS. of his *Essay on Criticism*, and several of his other works, he gave me himself, for the pains I took in collating the whole with its printed editions, at his request, on my having proposed to him the ‘making of an edition of his works in the manner of *Boileau*’.¹

The literary manuscripts which Pope gave to Richardson ‘include’, as Margaret Smith remarks in the *Index of English Literary Manuscripts*, ‘some of the most important surviving MSS of Pope’.² They were, as we shall see, accompanied in Richardson’s library by collated printed editions of Pope and some non-literary manuscripts. Their movements for a century and more after Richardson’s death have been summed up — not quite accurately — by Maynard Mack: they ‘made their way, without ever going on public sale, into the collection of Charles Chauncy, and finally, in 1887, to the marketplace’, the last point being minimally elaborated on in an endnote which reads ‘See the Sotheby sale catalogue, July 1887’.³ Charles Chauncy was a near-contemporary of Richardson the younger’s, a rich English physician and antiquary; the name is also spelt *Chauncey*, as in the *Oxford DNB* and several of the sources quoted below.

* I am grateful to Karen Thomson, who helped me to start thinking about this topic, and to James McLaverty, for his valuable comments on a draft.

1. Jonathan Richardson, *Richardsoniana, or, Occasional Reflections on the Moral Nature of Man* (London: Printed for J. Dodsley, 1776), 264; for Pope and the Richardsons, see William Kurtz Wimsatt, *The Portraits of Alexander Pope* (New Haven and London: Yale University Press, 1965), 73–89 and 137–222, esp. 142–143, Helene Koon, ‘Pope’s First Editors’, *Huntington Library Quarterly* 35.1 (1971), 19–27, and James McLaverty, *Pope, Print, and Meaning* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2001), 212–213; for Pope and Boileau, see McLaverty, op. cit., 87–90, 210–214.

2. Margaret M. Smith, ‘Alexander Pope’, in eadem and Alexander Lindsay, *Index of English Literary Manuscripts*, vol. 3, 1700–1800, part 3, *Alexander Pope—Sir Richard Steele* (London: Mansell, 1992), 1–78 at 2.

3. Maynard Mack, *Collected in Himself: Essays Critical, Biographical, and Bibliographical on Pope and Some of his Contemporaries* (East Brunswick, NJ: Associated University Presses, 1982), 325, 346 n 24.

The impressive terseness of Mack's account has led to its being overlooked. For instance, Smith's *IELM* entry records that 'The first major dispersal of Pope's MSS in the salerooms did not occur until the W. Nassau Lees Sale, at Christie's, 20 [sc. 30] July 1889' (2), and gives an account only of the sub-set of the Chauncy manuscripts which reached that sale, two years after the one which Mack mentions. Likewise, the current online catalogue record for the Morgan Library manuscript MA 348, the first extant draft of the 'Essay on Man', reads 'Presented by Pope to Jonathan Richardson (1694–1771); Dr. Charles Chauncey, and by descent in his family until at least 1860; General William Nassau Lees; his sale (Christie's, 30 July 1889, lot 79)'. Moreover, the Sotheby catalogue of 1887 to which Mack refers the reader is not widely available, and although it tells us much about the Richardson–Chauncy manuscripts of Pope, it does not tell the full story. The following is therefore the first full account of the eighteenth- and nineteenth-century career of the most important group of manuscripts of Pope.

I

Richardson evidently retained the manuscripts which Pope had given him until his death. They were sold in April 1776, by Baker and Leigh, with three associated lots.⁴ The catalogue describes the four lots as follows:

- 3170 Two Copper Plates of Mr. Pope's Head, one in a Circle, the other in a Whig [sic], by Richardson,⁵
 3171 Most of Mr. Pope's Poems in their first Sketches in his own hand Writing, and some first Editions corrected,
 3172 Mr. Pope's Pastorals, Manuscript, *neatly wrote*,

N. B. *This Copy is that which passed through the Hands of Walsh, Congreave, Mainwaring, Garth, Granville, Southerne, Sir W. Trumbull, Lord Halifax, Lord Wharton, Marq. of Dorchester, Duke of Bucks, &c. The Alterations from this Copy were upon the Objections of some of these, or my own.* A. Pope.⁶

4. *A Catalogue of the Very Large and Valuable Library of Doctor John Campbell ... To Which is Added, Some Original Letters of Mr. Pope to Mr. Richardson of Queen's Square, and also Many of his Works with his own Manuscript Corrections* (London: for S. Baker and G. Leigh, 1776), 99 [reproduced in the microfilm series *Sotheby Catalogues*, part I, reel 6 of 71].

5. Unidentified: Richardson the elder made a number of etched portraits of Pope, for which see Wimsatt, *Portraits of Alexander Pope*, 178–200. Cf. William Gregson, writing in or shortly after December 1775, in George Sherburn, 'New Anecdotes about Alexander Pope', *Notes & Queries* 203 (1958), 343–349 at 346: 'I have the plates of several of Mr Popes Heads, Sketch'd by my Grandfather [Richardson the elder], the best Proof I think is bound up, as Frontispiece to his Works.'

6. See Maynard Mack, ed., *The Last and Greatest Art: Some Unpublished Poetical Manuscripts of Alexander Pope* (Newark: University of Delaware Press, 1984), 19–21; Smith, 'Alexander Pope', entry PoA 273.

3173 Mr. Pope's original Letters to Mr. Richardson, sen. in his own Hand, together with his Dedication to all his Works, and transcript of what he dedicated [*sc.* dictated] to Mr. Richardson of his Birth and Publications, &c.⁷

Baker and Leigh's marked-up copy of the sale catalogue in the British Library records three of the buyers, and a copy in the Bodleian supplies the prices: Lot 3170 went for £1 7s. to an unidentified buyer; Lot 3171 for £5 5s. to Dr. Chauncey; Lot 3172 for £1 1s. to Grigson (William Gregson, grandson of Jonathan Richardson the elder, who gave it to the radical Thomas Brand Hollis); and Lot 3173 for £1 11s. 6d. to G. Davies.⁸

Charles Chauncy did not enjoy his purchase for long, for he died on Christmas Day, 1777. His will (PROB 11/1038/53) bequeaths 'all my Books Mss Book Cases Pictures' and the like to his brother Nathaniel. When he first drafted the will, which is dated 10 March 1776, he added that he desired that his collections 'may not be seperated or disposed of but kept entire and together' to be inherited in due course by whichever of the three sons of his deceased sister Martha Snell should be thought most deserving of them (Charles himself was childless, and neither Nathaniel nor his other brother Philip had sons, so the three Snell brothers were his only male nephews).⁹ However, he subsequently struck this passage out, and the will as proved on 8 January 1778 makes no restriction as to the future of the books or collections. Nathaniel Chauncy kept them together for his lifetime, but his collections of books and other objects were dispersed, 'by his express order', in a series of sales by auction after his death in 1790.¹⁰

However, the Pope manuscripts were not among the books sold at this time. A note in one of them records that it passed from Charles Chauncy to Nathaniel, and thence to one of the Snell nephews, another Charles, who married Nathaniel's daughter Amelia, and changed his name in 1783 to Charles Snell Chauncy.¹¹ Since the whole collection was still together in 1887, it must in fact all have passed to Charles Snell Chauncy. By his will (PROB 11/1500/155, fol. 254r),

7. Pope's letters to Richardson are now widely dispersed (see references at Smith, 'Alexander Pope', 13–14). The manuscript of a draft of the 'Preface' to the 1717 *Works* was, in the nineteenth century, preserved in an album of materials relating to Pope which also included one of his letters to Jonathan Richardson the elder (Smith, 'Alexander Pope', 16–17 and PoA 400), but only very loosely could this have been called Pope's 'Dedication to all his Works'. For the 'transcript', see 'Transcript of what Mr. Pope dictated to Mr. Jonathan Richardson Senn. at Twickenham 5th August 1739', Bodleian MS Eng. lett. d. 59, fos. 80–81, copied by William Gregson in December 1775 (perhaps from the manuscript sold in April 1776); Sherburn, 'New Anecdotes about Alexander Pope', 346–347, correct title supplied by Maynard Mack, *Alexander Pope: A Life* (New York: W. W. Norton, 1985), 823 n 13.

8. The British Library copy (from the set pressmarked S. C. Sotheby) is the one reproduced in the microfilm series *Sotheby Catalogues*; the Bodleian copy is Mus. Bibl. III. 351. The purchase of lot 3171 by Chauncy was noted in *Gentleman's Magazine* 47.1 (January 1777), 9.

9. S. I. Tucker, *Pedigree of the Family of Chauncy*, private ed. (London: Mitchell and Hughes, 1884), 9–10.

10. For the order, see *Gentleman's Magazine* 60.1 (January 1790), 87; the sale devoted to books was catalogued in *A Catalogue of the Elegant and Valuable Libraries of Charles Chauncy ... and of his Brother Nathaniel Chauncy, Esq., Both Deceased* (London: for Leigh and Sotheby, 1790).

11. The note is reported in David L. Vander Meulen, *Pope's DUNCIAD of 1728: A History and Facsimile* (Charlottesville and London: University Press of Virginia for the Bibliographical Society of the University of Virginia and the New York Public Library, 1991), 42.

he left 'all my Household Furniture Plate Linen China Printed Books Wines and other Liquors Carriages and Horses' to his widow at his death in 1809, and there appears to have been no quarrel over the fact that the form of words 'printed books' does not cover manuscripts. She in turn left her books to her daughter Charlotte Chauncy by her will, proved in 1841 (PROB 11/1940/325), but Charlotte appears to have predeceased her, and the movement of the books within the Chauncy family for the next 46 years is unclear. In 1887, however, the barrister and antiquary William Thorpe wrote a letter to the *Times* about a completely different manuscript with a Chauncy provenance, in which he stated that 'I am informed by the family solicitor, Mr. Teesdale ... that when the Chauncy collections were disposed of by ... Sotheby in 1790, the autographs were retained by the family, who have now sent them to the hammer' (*Times*, 17 September 1887, 7; repeated in essentials *Times*, 4 October 1887, 3). The solicitor in question, John Marmaduke Teesdale, had married a Chauncy (see his obituary in *Law Times*, 16 June 1888, 128), so he was in a good position to know the family history.

II

The catalogue of Sotheby's sale of July 1887, to which Mack alludes so briefly, included a series of lots headed 'Pope (Alexander) Autograph Manuscripts, From the Library of the late Dr. Charles Chauncy', and this series provides the fullest account of the set of manuscripts which had passed by inheritance through the generations of the Chauncy family in the 111 years since Charles's purchase in April 1776.¹² The catalogue entries are transcribed here (text to the right of the vertical line is right-aligned in the original) with notes on how each adds to our knowledge of the Richardson–Chauncy manuscripts of Pope; prices realized and buyers are from the microfilm reproduction of the auctioneer's copy in the British Library.¹³

477 The Essay on Man, with numerous MS. Notes and Corrections in Pope's handwriting, *uncut, and errata in first edition*, 8vo 1736 | (2)

£10 to Benjamin Franklin Stevens. Two volumes are catalogued here, one an edition of 1736, and one a first edition. The first volume, 'The Essay on Man, with numerous MS. Notes and Corrections in Pope's handwriting, uncut ... 8vo 1736', is surely to be identified with Pope's revised copy of *Works* II (1736), now in the British Library, C. 122. e. 31 (Smith, 'Alexander Pope' 6–7), since this

12. *Catalogue of the Choice Library of the Late William Brice, Esq., of Bristol ... To which are added ... Pope's Autograph Manuscripts* (London: for Sotheby, Wilkinson, and Hodge, 1887), 40–41 [reproduced in the microfilm series *Sotheby Catalogues*, part 2, reel 105 of 148].

13. The report of prices realized in *The Athenaeum*, no. 3120 (13 August 1887), 215, 'omitted the odd shillings' but otherwise agrees with the auctioneer's copy. *The Times*, no. 32139 (1 August 1887), 4, stated that the manuscripts 'were catalogued separately, but it was agreed to sell them as one lot, and they were accordingly so put up and sold for £220 5s.'; this was indeed the total sum realized, and seven of the eleven lots did go to a single purchaser, but the account is obviously garbled.

volume begins with *An Essay on Man*.¹⁴ It has not previously been identified as a Richardson–Chauncy book. The second volume, 'The Essay on Man, with ... *errata in first edition*', must be 'the volume now in the Berg collection [79-432] that contained among other Pope material a copy of the *Essay on Man* and the manuscript of the *First Satire of the Second Book of Horace*', for this copy, annotated in a hand or hands other than Pope's, has Chauncy ownership inscriptions, and was, as we shall see, with the other Richardson–Chauncy books when Elwin collated it.¹⁵

478 The Dunciad, FIRST EDITION, LARGE PAPER, *frontispiece, filled with MS. Notes and corrections from the first Broghio MS. by Mr. Pope himself, uncut* | 8vo. Dublin, 1728

£13 to Thompson. This is the 1728 *Dunciad*, actually annotated by Jonathan Richardson rather than by 'Mr. Pope himself', which is now in the Berg collection of the New York Public Library (Smith, 'Alexander Pope', entry PoA 32), and was reproduced in facsimile with commentary by David Vander Meulen in 1991. Vander Meulen notes that this copy and the other two *Dunciads* listed here all have the manuscript date 1777 on their title pages, which 'seems to indicate that in that year they were part of a single collection, probably that of Dr. Charles Chauncy ... or his brother and heir Nathaniel. . . . But then parts of the trail become obscure'.¹⁶ We can now be confident that all three *Dunciads* were Richardson–Chauncy books; that the collection was still Charles's until the end of 1777 (he died on 25 December but his will was not proved until 1778); and that they remained in the family until 1887, when they were sold as Lots 478, 479, and 480. Thompson bought six other lots in the 1887 sale; the six others all went to the library of William Nassau Lees, sold in 1889; this is therefore doubtless the annotated *Dunciad* which was Lot 75 in Nassau Lees' sale, described by Smith ('Alexander Pope', 2) as unlocated. It is, by the way, an odd coincidence that just as Charles Chauncy bought the Richardson manuscripts of Pope in April 1776 and died twenty months later, in December 1777, so Nassau Lees bought them in July 1887 and died twenty months later, in March 1889.

479 The Dunciad. Another copy, LARGE PAPER, *frontispiece, with MS. corrections, copied from Pope's copy by Jonathan Richardson junr. uncut* | 8vo. ib. 1728

£7 7s. to Colonel (Francis) Grant. This is the 1728 *Dunciad* now at the Huntington Library, 106517 (Smith, 'Alexander Pope', PoA 34), which was bought by B. F. Stevens at Grant's sale, was in the library of Robert Hoe by 1905, and was bought by Huntington at the Hoe sale in 1912; Vander Meulen remarks of this and the

14. The volume was sold at Sotheby's on 10 February 1971, to Charles Traylen, an English bookdealer acting ultimately for Yale University Library, but its export was, controversially, prevented: see Peter Hopkirk, 'Dispute over plans to export Pope manuscript [sic]', *The Times*, 15 January 1971, 3, and subsequent letters to *The Times* by Peter Eaton (2 February 1971, 15), Charles Traylen (10 February 1971, 13), and P. J. Korshin (24 March 1971, 15). Its British Museum accession stamp is dated 30 September 1971.

15. Vander Meulen, *Pope's DUNCIAD of 1728*, 42; the manuscript is Smith, 'Alexander Pope', PoA 181.

16. Vander Meulen, *Pope's DUNCIAD of 1728*, 42.

1736 copy that their 'early histories ... are more mysterious. . . . How these left the Chauncy family is unclear, though they may have been dispersed in the Leigh and Sotheby sale' of Nathaniel Chauncy's library in 1790.¹⁷ We now see that both remained in the hands of the descendants of Nathaniel Chauncy until 1887.

- 480 The *Dunciad*, with Notes Variorum, LARGE PAPER, *frontispiece, with numerous MS. Notes and corrections from his second MS. by Mr. Pope himself, uncut* | 8vo. 1736

£8 8s. to (J.) Pearson. This is the 1736 *Dunciad* now in the Berg collection (Smith, 'Alexander Pope', PoA 33). Vander Meulen notes that in 1888 it was owned by Richard Tangye; for his remarks on its earlier history, see Lot 479.

- 481 Sapho to Phaon, wholly translated, AUTOGRAPH MS. OF POPE | *folio*. 1707

- 482 Essay on Criticism, AUTOGRAPH MS. OF POPE | *folio*. 1709

- 483 Windsor-Forest, AUTOGRAPH MS. OF POPE, *wanting a few lines at end* | *folio*. 1709

Respectively £17, £28, and £20 to Thompson, and thus to Nassau Lees; identified as Richardson–Chauncy books at his sale, where they were Lots 76, 77, and 78 respectively, but their history in the years before he acquired them has previously been incomplete (Smith, 'Alexander Pope', 2 and PoA 297, PoA 160, PoA 376–377 respectively). Now respectively at the Morgan Library, MA 349; the Bodleian Library, MS Eng. poet. c. 1; and Washington University in St. Louis. At some point before 1887, the manuscripts of *Essay on Criticism* and *Windsor-Forest* were brought together, and the title-page of the former had the title of the latter added to it, but they were separated again before the sale.¹⁸

- 484 ESSAY ON MAN, in IV Epistles, Epistle I to III, AUTOGRAPH MS. OF POPE, *Epistle IV printed with numerous MS. corrections by Pope himself* | *folio*. n.d.

£50 to Thompson, and thus to Nassau Lees, and Lot 79 at his sale (see 481–483 above); the manuscript portion is now in the Morgan Library, and the printed copy of Epistle IV is unlocated (Smith, 'Alexander Pope', 2 and PoA 164, 168). This must be what Richardson meant by 'the first scratches of the four books' of the *Essay on Man* which he possessed.

- 485 Epistle on Taste, AUTOGRAPH MS. OF POPE, with his numerous alterations and corrections | *folio*. n.d.

£ 25 10s. to Quaritch. After her account of the Richardson–Chauncy books in the Nassau Lees sale, Smith states ('Alexander Pope', 2) that 'Further MSS from the Chauncy collection appeared on the market later, in the Stuart M. Samuel sale, Sotheby's, 1 July 1907.' In fact, only one manuscript with a clear Richardson–Chauncy provenance did so: 'Lot 111, specified as from Charles Chauncy's

17. Vander Meulen, *Pope's DUNCIAD of 1728*, 44–45.

18. For the title-page, see Robert M. Schmitz, *Pope's Windsor Forest: A Study of the Washington University Holograph* (St Louis: Washington University, 1952), 14, and idem, *Pope's Essay on Criticism 1709: A Study of the Bodleian Manuscript Text with Facsimiles, Transcripts, and Variants* (St. Louis: Washington University Press, 1962), 29.

library, was described as an autograph MS of a text which had not been represented at all in the 1889 sale', namely this one, the 'Epistle on Taste', or *Epistle to Burlington*. We now see that it had been sold as from Charles Chauncy's library in 1887, but not to Thompson, and had therefore not passed to Nassau Lees. The 1887 and 1911 catalogue entries both appear to refer to the same manuscript, an autograph of the *Epistle to Burlington* with a Chauncy provenance. Smith ('Alexander Pope', 2–3 and PoA 76) discusses the likelihood of its identification with Morgan Library MA 352, in which one leaf of the *Epistle to Burlington* is followed by eight leaves of the *Epistle to Dr. Arbuthnot*. The Morgan fragment was indeed collated by Jonathan Richardson.¹⁹ And, as we shall see below, its readings correspond to those transcribed by Whitwell Elwin from a manuscript which, when he saw it, was in the possession of the Chauncy family.

486 Ethic Epistles I to III, AUTOGRAPH MS. OF POPE, *with numerous alterations and corrections by himself* | 4to.

£20 to Thompson. This fair copy — 'a superb example of [Pope's] calligraphy' as Peter Croft called it — must be what Richardson meant by 'the several finished copies, (of his own neat and elegant writing)' which he possessed, 'several' referring to the different 'books' of the *Essay on Man* identified in the previous clause in Richardson's memoir.²⁰

The two manuscripts of the *Essay on Man* in the 1887 sale both passed from the Chauncy family via Thompson to Nassau Lees. One of the Nassau Lees copies (484 above) is, as we have just seen, at the Morgan Library; the other, Lot 80 at the Nassau Lees sale, was catalogued as 'Ethic Epistles I–III', and can surely be identified both with the present copy and with the manuscript of the *Essay on Man* now at Harvard, which bears the same title (Smith, 'Alexander Pope', 2–4 and PoA 165). The Harvard manuscript was offered for sale by Dodd, Mead and Co. of New York in 1910.²¹

A manuscript sold as Lot 112 in the Stuart M. Samuel sale in 1907 also bore the title 'Ethic Epistles'. There are two ways to explain this. The first is that two manuscripts bore this title: the one now at Harvard, and the one in the Samuel sale. In that case, there were three manuscripts of the *Essay on Man* in all: the one now at the Morgan, the one now at Harvard, and a third, now unlocated, known only from its appearance in the Samuel sale catalogue. Smith proposes, on several grounds, that this was the case, and if she is right, the chronology of sales must have been as follows: 1887, the present Harvard MS is sold to Nassau Lees; 1889, the present Harvard MS is sold at Nassau Lees' sale; 1907, a previously unknown MS with the same title appears at Samuel's sale, is sold to Sabin, and is never seen again; 1910, the present Harvard MS is offered for sale by Dodd, Mead and Co. An alternative explanation is that there were only two

19. See Mack, ed., *Last and Greatest Art*, 159 n 2.

20. P. J. Croft, *Autograph Poetry in the English Language* (London: Cassell, 1973), 1. 70.

21. *Alexander Pope: Notes Towards a Bibliography of Early Editions of his Writings: A Catalogue of Marshall C. Lefferts's Great Collection of First and Later Editions of the Works of Alexander Pope, with the Autograph Manuscript of an Essay on Man* (New York: Dodd, Mead and Company, [1910]), 49–50; identified with the Harvard manuscript in Smith, 'Alexander Pope', 3.

manuscripts of the *Essay on Man*, the one now at the Morgan and the one now at Harvard, and that the latter was sold in 1887, 1889, and 1907, before being offered for sale by Dodd, Mead and Co. in 1910.

Of interest to us here is the question of whether the postulated third manuscript could also have had a Chauncy provenance. Smith suggests that it could, arguing that the 'Epistle on Taste' manuscript, 485 above, was catalogued as Lot 111 in the Samuel sale with a note of its Chauncy provenance, and that the 'Ethic Epistles' was catalogued as Lot 112, and 'by virtue of its juxtaposition to Lot 111 may also have come from Chauncey'. She also notes that a manuscript of Epistle IV of the *Essay on Man* was acquired by Pierpont Morgan in 1909, and argues that 'this suggests that there were more Chauncey MSS in circulation than had reached the sale rooms in 1889'. So there were, as we have seen: the Chauncy family sold their manuscripts in 1887, and not all of these were bought by Nassau Lees to return to the market in 1889. But the only Pope manuscript with a definite Chauncy provenance which Smith can identify as having been sold after 1889 without having been part of the Nassau Lees sale is the 'Epistle on Taste' manuscript which, as we have seen, was sold as Lot 485 with the Chauncy manuscripts in 1887. There is no reason to believe that the Chauncy family withheld any of their literary manuscripts from the sale of 1887 for separate sale at around the same time, and the statement made at that time by their family lawyer suggests that they did not do so. In that case, if the Samuel manuscript of the *Essay on Man* is to be distinguished from the manuscripts now at the Morgan Library and Harvard, it was never a Chauncy manuscript. That is of course perfectly possible — Charles Chauncy bought all of Jonathan Richardson's literary manuscripts of Pope apart from the *Pastorals*, but there were manuscripts which Richardson, and therefore Chauncy, never possessed, for instance the manuscript of Epistle IV which has just been mentioned — but a hypothetical Chauncy provenance cannot be part of the argument for the existence of a third *Essay on Man* manuscript.

- 487 Epistle III to Lord Bathurst. THE ORIGINAL AUTOGRAPH MS. OF POPE, with his numerous alterations and corrections, wanting 8 lines at end. Transcript of the same by Mr. Pope, with his autograph corrections and alterations, and the printed edition of Epistles III to VII, with numerous MS. corrections and alterations by Pope himself. Also Epistle II, AUTOGRAPH MS. OF POPE, with his MS. alterations and corrections | folio.

£21 to Thompson, and thence to Nassau Lees, at whose sale the same body of material was Lot 81: the manuscript of 'Epistle II', the *Epistle to a Lady*, is now unlocated; the two manuscripts of 'Epistle III', the *Epistle to Bathurst*, are now Huntington HM 6007 and 6008; 'the printed edition of Epistles III to VII, with numerous MS. corrections and alterations by Pope himself' is extracted from Pope's *Works*, volume II (1735), with collations in Richardson's hand rather than Pope's, and is now Huntington HM 6009 (Smith, 'Alexander Pope', 2 and PoA 65, 67–70).²²

22. HM 6007 and 6008 are reproduced in Earl R. Wasserman, *Pope's Epistle to Bathurst: A Critical Reading, with an Edition of the Manuscripts* (Baltimore: Johns Hopkins Press, 1960). A somewhat fuller description of HM 6009 is in Koon, 'Pope's First Editors', 22.

III

One final question remains to be asked about the Richardson–Chauncy manuscripts in the period between their acquisition by Jonathan Richardson during the lifetime of Pope and their sale by the Chauncy family in 1887: what light is shed on them by the Elwin–Courthope edition of Pope, in which some of them are cited? Elwin wrote in his preface to the first volume, published in 1871, that

Pope presented several of his manuscripts to the son of Jonathan Richardson, the portrait-painter. . . . Richardson's interlined copy of the first quarto volume of Pope's poetry passed into the hands of Malone, and was ultimately bought by Mr. Croker. The manuscripts which Richardson possessed in the handwriting of Pope were purchased by Dr. Chauncey, and are still the property of his descendants.²³

'Richardson's interlined copy of the first quarto volume of Pope's poetry' is the copy of the 1717 *Works* presented by Pope to Jonathan Richardson the elder, bearing notes in Malone's hand, which is now in the Berg Collection (Smith, 'Alexander Pope', 12). This copy was, as Elwin reports elsewhere, annotated by Richardson the younger, but was evidently not included with the 'first Editions corrected' in the sale of 1776.²⁴ Having been in Croker's possession, it was no doubt among the materials of Croker's on which Elwin founded his work, and readings from it occur in Elwin's first two volumes.²⁵ There are points at which Elwin appears to be citing, and strangely misrepresenting, Pope's manuscripts, when I suspect that he is actually working from Richardson's annotations.²⁶

In his introduction to the third volume of the Elwin–Courthope edition, Courthope thanked Elwin 'for his liberality in allowing me to use his transcript of the Chauncy MS., which throws so much light on the meaning of Pope's satires'; he referred again, a few pages later, to 'the transcript which Mr. Elwin has made from the Chauncy MS.'²⁷ This form of words suggests that Courthope did not realize that the transcript which Elwin had communicated to him included readings from multiple manuscripts.²⁸ The first references to the 'Chauncy MS.' in the collations in this volume are in those to the *Epistle to Bathurst*, where its readings correspond to those of Huntington HM 6007 and HM 6008 (Lot 487

23. *The Works of Alexander Pope*, ed. Whitwell Elwin and W. J. Courthope, 10 vols. (London: John Murray, 1871), 1. xviii.

24. Of course, a book might in theory have been owned by Chauncy and then Malone if the latter had bought it at the Chauncy sale of 1790, of which he owned a catalogue — see *A Catalogue of the Greater Portion of the Library of the Late Edmond Malone, Esq.* (London: Sotheby, 1818), 12 (Lot 371) — but there was no 1717 *Works* of Pope in the Chauncy sale.

25. *Works of Alexander Pope*, ed. Elwin and Courthope, 1. 90, 97 (*Sappho to Phaon*), 1. 323–332, 346–347 (*Windsor-Forest*), 2. 10, 42 n 3, etc. (*Essay on Criticism*), 2. 420 (*Essay on Man*).

26. See the discussions of some of these readings in Schmitz, *Pope's Windsor Forest*, 13, and idem, *Pope's Essay on Criticism 1709*, 22; Schmitz did not realize that Elwin was working from Richardson's annotations rather than from the holograph, and therefore saw some of his readings as 'incorrect to the point of curiosity' (*Pope's Essay*, 22).

27. *Works of Alexander Pope*, ed. Elwin and Courthope, 3. x, 18.

28. Vander Meulen, *Pope's DUNCIAD of 1728*, 43 proposes that Courthope's 'MS.' is 'probably to be construed as plural', but a simple misunderstanding on Courthope's part seems likelier.

above).²⁹ It is then cited in the *Epistle to Burlington*, where its readings correspond to those of the first leaf of Morgan Library MA 352 (Lot 485 above).³⁰ It is cited in the *Epistle to Dr. Arbuthnot*, where its readings correspond to those of subsequent leaves of Morgan Library MA 352 (Elwin had remarked in his introduction to the first volume that a copy of this poem was *among* 'the manuscripts which Richardson possessed in the handwriting of Pope').³¹ And it is cited in *The First Satire of the Second Book of Horace*, where its readings correspond to those in the Berg manuscript formerly attached to a printed copy of the *Essay on Man* (lot 477 part 2 above).³² So, all of these 'Chauncy MS.' readings are, as we might have expected, from manuscripts which can be identified with those sold in 1887. Furthermore, Courthope noted in his edition of the *Dunciad* that 'Jonathan Richardson corrected the first edition of the "Dunciad" from what he calls "the first Broglio MS."' His corrections have been transcribed by Mr. Elwin, and are here preserved'; as Vander Meulen has observed, 'Undoubtedly Elwin transcribed Richardson's notes from the current Berg copy' (lot 478 above).³³

In one other reference to 'the Richardson papers', I think that Elwin uses a form of words which, although not inaccurate, is misleading: 'The manuscript of Pope's Pastorals is still preserved among the Richardson papers'.³⁴ His further description makes it certain that this is the manuscript which was Lot 3172 at the sale of 1776, but this manuscript was, as we have seen, not bought by Chauncy, and although it is possible that it might subsequently have been bought as an addition to the collection of Pope manuscripts which had passed by inheritance through the generations of the Chauncy family, it seems unlikely that it would then have been kept from the sale of 1887 in which the collection was dispersed. Elwin presumably meant simply that the manuscript had a Richardson provenance — and, interestingly, that it was not alone. He specifies one of its companions: 'The Richardson collection contains a manuscript in which the poet has transcribed from his Pastorals the various lines he thought defective, and ... referred the task of selection to Walsh, who has jotted down his decisions at the bottom of Pope's remarks'.³⁵ This is certainly the manuscript (Smith, 'Alexander Pope', PoA 274) which, having long been a companion to the autograph fair copy of the *Pastorals*, was sold separately from it at the Houghton sale of 1980, and was Lot 381 in the Roy Davids sale at Bonhams, 8 May 2013.

29. *Works of Alexander Pope*, ed. Elwin and Courthope, 3. 127–157 passim; Wasserman, *Pope's Epistle to Bathurst*, 60 notes that the 'Chauncy MS' readings derive from the Huntington manuscripts.

30. *Works of Alexander Pope*, ed. Elwin and Courthope, 3. 172–178 passim (cf. Mack, ed., *Last and Greatest Art*, 160–162); 'the ignoble shout of Guise' (3. 172) is a bad emendation of the manuscript reading 'the noble shout of Guise'.

31. *Works of Alexander Pope*, ed. Elwin and Courthope, 3. 241–273 passim (cf. Mack, ed., *Last and Greatest Art*, 424–430 and 436–450); Elwin's reference to plural manuscripts is *Works*, I. xviii.

32. *Works of Alexander Pope*, ed. Elwin and Courthope, 3. 289–300 passim, and 3. 279, 400 n 2 (cf. Mack, ed., *Last and Greatest Art*, 172–186).

33. *Works of Alexander Pope*, ed. Elwin and Courthope, 4. 271 n 2; Vander Meulen, *Pope's DUNGLAD* of 1728, 43.

34. *Works of Alexander Pope*, ed. Elwin and Courthope, I. 239.

35. *Works of Alexander Pope*, ed. Elwin and Courthope, I. 240.

IV

In conclusion, then, we can list Jonathan Richardson the younger's Pope books as follows, dividing the Richardson–Chauncy group from the others, with PoA numbers from Smith, 'Alexander Pope'.

BOUGHT BY CHAUNCY AS LOT 3171 IN THE SALE OF 1776

1. *Essay on Man*, 1736, 'with numerous MS. Notes and Corrections in Pope's handwriting': part of Lot 477 in 1887; now British Library, C. 122. e. 31 (PoA 174 etc.: each work in the volume has a PoA number).
2. *Essay on Man*, 'first edition': part of Lot 477 in 1887; probably the marked-up copy now in the Berg Collection of New York Public Library, 79-432, which included a holograph of the *First Satire of the Second Book of Horace*, also in the Berg Collection (PoA 181).
3. *Dunciad*, 1728, 'with MS. Notes and corrections from the first Broglio MS': Lot 478 in 1887; now in the Berg Collection (PoA 32).
4. *Dunciad*, 1728, also with collations: Lot 479 in 1887; now at the Huntington Library, 106517 (PoA 34).
5. *Dunciad*, 1736, 'with numerous MS. Notes and corrections from his second MS. by Mr. Pope himself': Lot 480 in 1887; now in the Berg Collection (PoA 33).
6. *Sapho to Phaon*, holograph: Lot 481 in 1877; now at the Morgan Library, MA 349 (PoA 297).
7. *Essay on Criticism*, holograph: Lot 482 in 1877; now in the Bodleian, MS Eng. poet. c. 1 (PoA 160).
8. *Windsor-Forest*, holograph: Lot 483 in 1877; now at Washington University (PoA 376).
9. *Essay on Man*, Epistles I–III holograph, and Epistle IV an annotated printed edition: Lot 484 in 1887; the holograph portion now Morgan Library MA 348 (PoA 164) and the printed portion now unlocated (PoA 168).
10. *Epistle to Burlington*, holograph: Lot 485 in 1887; almost certainly really one leaf of the *Epistle to Burlington* followed by a holograph of the *Epistle to Dr. Arbuthnot*, and in that case, now Morgan Library MA 352, fols. 1 (PoA 76) and 2–9 (PoA 81).
11. *Essay on Man*, Epistles I–III, holograph: Lot 486 in 1887; now Harvard, fMS Eng. 233. 1 (PoA 165).
12. *Epistle to Bathurst*, holograph: part of Lot 487 in 1887; now Huntington, HM 6007 and 6008 (PoA 67–69).
13. Pages from the *Works*, vol. II (1735), with Richardson's collations of the *Epistle to Bathurst*: part of Lot 487 in 1887; now Huntington, HM 6009 (PoA 70).
14. *Epistle to a Lady*, holograph: part of Lot 487 in 1887; unlocated (PoA 65).

NOT BOUGHT BY CHAUNCY

15. *Pastorals*, holograph: part of Lot 3172 in 1776; Houghton sale, 1980 (PoA 273).

16. 'Alterations to the Pastoralls', partly holograph: part of Lot 3172 in 1776; Roy Davids sale, 2013 (PoA 274).
17. 'Mr. Pope's original Letters to Mr. Richardson, sen.', holograph: part of Lot 3173 in 1776; now probably dispersed.
18. 'Dedication to all his Works', perhaps holograph: part of Lot 3173 in 1776; now unlocated, unless it is to be identified with the draft of the 'Preface' to the 1717 *Works* now in the John Murray album at Yale (PoA 400).
19. 'Transcript of what he dedicated [*sc.* dictated] to Mr. Richardson of his Birth and Publications': part of Lot 3173 in 1776; now unlocated, but transcribed in 1775 as Bodleian, MS Eng. lett. d. 59, fols. 80–81.
20. *Works* (1717), presented by Pope to Jonathan Richardson the elder, and marked up with collations by Jonathan Richardson the younger: not in the 1776 sale; now in the Berg Collection.